

Townsend 2.1-2.4

Questions for Gallicchio

how is $|\psi\rangle\langle\psi|$ different from $\langle\psi||\psi\rangle$? If its $1 \times N$ vs $N \times 1$, we still just end up with one number when doing matrix multiplication? How does the $|+z\rangle\langle+z| + |-z\rangle\langle-z|$ multiply out to make the identity?

2.1

We define the adjoint which takes conjugate transpose (hermitian?)[†]. This take $|\rangle \rightarrow \langle|$

We introduce the rotation generator operator $\hat{j}$ which takes infinitesimal rotations

$$\hat{R}(d\phi\mathbf{k}) = 1 - \frac{i}{\hbar} \hat{J}_z d\phi$$

Which is self adjoint, and satisfies

$$\hat{R}^\dagger(d\phi\mathbf{k})\hat{R}(d\phi\mathbf{k}) = \left(1 + \frac{i}{\hbar} \hat{J}_z^\dagger d\phi\right) \left(1 - \frac{i}{\hbar} \hat{J}_z d\phi\right)$$

The operator undoes itself when acting with argument angles rotated by π .

Taking $N \rightarrow \infty$ actions of this $\hat{J}_z$ rotation generator, we can deflect by any angle?

Doing the rotation to make an overall phase doesn't change the state, i.e.

$$\hat{J}_z|z\rangle = |z\rangle$$

This introduces Eigenkets.

We have projection operators $\hat{P}_\pm$ that compose to make an identity operator.

$$|\psi\rangle = \underbrace{(|+z\rangle\langle+z|)}_{\hat{P}_+} + \underbrace{(|-z\rangle\langle-z|)}_{\hat{P}_-} |\psi\rangle$$

Where each projection finds the component along a vector

$$\hat{P}_+|\psi\rangle = |+z\rangle \langle+z|\psi\rangle$$

This is the component of psi that lies along the z direction for the $+z$ ket.

Blocking a path in the Modified Stern Gerlach that recombines beams is the same as taking the projection, and just leaving one portion.

We can write these as matrix representations, so

$$\vec{P}_+ = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \vec{P}_- = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

or the rotation generator

$$\hat{J}_z = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\hbar}{2} & 0 \\ 0 & -\frac{\hbar}{2} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\text{if } \hat{A}|\psi\rangle = \phi$$

$$\langle\chi|\hat{A}|\psi\rangle = \langle\chi|\phi\rangle$$

$$\langle\psi|\hat{A}^\dagger|\chi\rangle = \langle\phi|\chi\rangle$$